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Harry Anthony Patrinos

Education Remains One of the Best Investments We Can Make < [https://hpatrinos.com/2026/06/09/edu cation-remains-one-of-the-best- investments-we-can-make/](https://hpatrinos.com/2026/06/09/education-remains-one-of-the-best-investments-we-can-make/)>

Our entry in the live Handbook of Labor, Human Resources and Population Economics. We highlight the enduring evidence that education is a powerful form of human capital investment, generating substantial private and social returns. Education remains one of the best investments individuals and

societies can make. The evidence is remarkably consistent: higher levels of education

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Learning Pays More Than Schooling < <https://hpatrinos.com/2026/06/04/learning-pays-more-than-schooling/>>

For decades, the economics of education has delivered a remarkably consistent finding: more education leads to higher earnings. But there is an important question that often gets overlooked. What matters more: how long students stay in school, or how much they actually learn? My latest substack: <https://harryapatrinos.substack.com/p/learning-pays-more-than-schooling> < <https://harryapatrinos.substack.com/p/learning-pays-more-than-schooling>>

Human Capital Is Climate Policy < <https://hpatrinos.com/2026/05/02/human-capital-is-climate-policy/>>

I presented this work at the SustainableED 2026 Conference at the Annenberg Institute at Brown University on May 1, 2026, where I spoke on A Review of Human Development and Environmental Outcomes (slides attached). This question—whether education can influence climate outcomes—has long been assumed, but rarely tested with credible causal evidence. In a recent paper

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Designing Effective PPPs in Education: **Does governance design matter more** **than private provision <** **[https://hpatrinos.com/2026/04/17/designing-effective-ppps-in-](https://hpatrinos.com/2026/04/17/designing-effective-ppps-in-educationdoes-governance-design-matter-more-than-private-provision/)** **[educationdoes-governance-design-](https://hpatrinos.com/2026/04/17/designing-effective-ppps-in-educationdoes-governance-design-matter-more-than-private-provision/)** **[matter-more-than-private-provision/>](https://hpatrinos.com/2026/04/17/designing-effective-ppps-in-educationdoes-governance-design-matter-more-than-private-provision/)**

My presentation from the 2026 AERA meetings. This paper examines publicly funded school choice as a form of education public-private partnership (PPP) and evaluates whether cross-national differences in system performance correspond to institutional design rather than private provision alone. Using structured comparative case analysis and policy benchmarking data, six countries and the fragmented U.S. model

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Education Pays – And Now We Know **It's Causal <** **[https://hpatrinos.com/2026/03/23/edu](https://hpatrinos.com/2026/03/23/education-pays-and-now-we-know-its-causal/)** **[cation-pays-and-now-we-know-its-](https://hpatrinos.com/2026/03/23/education-pays-and-now-we-know-its-causal/)** **[causal/>](https://hpatrinos.com/2026/03/23/education-pays-and-now-we-know-its-causal/)**

For years, a familiar critique has shadowed one of the most robust findings in economics: people with more education earn more. Yes – but is it causal? Do schools actually raise earnings? Or are more able, more motivated individuals simply more likely to stay in school? In a new paper with George Psacharopoulos, published in the International Journal

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New in The 74: Arkansas' 3rd-grade
retention is coming — but retention
isn't the reform <
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[the-reform/>](https://hpatrinos.com/2026/02/21/new-in-the-74-arkansas-3rd-grade-retention-is-coming-but-retention-isnt-the-reform/)

Arkansas is about to implement a high-stakes element of the Right to Read Act: beginning this summer, third-graders who aren't reading proficiently can be retained. That reality is creating understandable anxiety for families and educators. In my new The 74 analysis, I make a simple, evidence-based point: retention by itself won't raise literacy. What moved

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Department of Education Reform: **Impact in Arkansas <** **<https://hpatrinos.com/2026/02/05/department-of-education-reform-impact-in-arkansas/>>**

Our latest newsletter highlights how the Department of Education Reform, Arkansas Teacher Corps, and the Office for Education Policy are making a real impact across Arkansas. This month's spotlight features new research on the returns to education in Arkansas, updates on teacher pipeline initiatives, evidence-based policy work with schools and state leaders, and upcoming lectures

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Can More Schooling Change How We **Act on Climate? <** **<https://hpatrinos.com/2026/01/10/can-more-schooling-change-how-we-act-on-climate/>>**

I'm pleased to share a new paper, co-authored with Diego Ambasz and Anshuman Gupta, A review of human development and environmental outcomes. Although there is now substantial research on how climate and environmental conditions affect human development, much less is known about the reverse channel: can education itself help mitigate climate change and improve environmental

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Can Tutoring—and Technology—Finally Solve Bloom's Two Sigma Problem? < <https://hpatrinos.com/2025/11/25/can-tutoring-and-technology-finally-solve-blooms-two-sigma-problem/>>

My blog on Getting Smart:

<https://www.gettingsmart.com/2025/11/25/can-tutoring-and-technology-finally-solve-blooms-two-sigma-problem/> <
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